

FieldPulse Research Pack — Dispatcher Interview Transcripts

Day 4 · Research Pack (1 of 6). Three anonymized dispatcher interviews, transcribed and lightly edited for length. Quotes are **Reported** evidence; interviewer's field observations are marked **Observed**. Corroborate across sources — do not treat any single quote as validated fact.

Anonymized: names changed, shop sizes preserved within a band, identifying details removed. Interviewer contributions in brackets.

Interview A — "Maria R."

Profile: 12 years dispatching · 90-technician HVAC shop · runs the board solo on weekdays · self-described "notebook person"

[Walk me through a normal morning.]

A1. "I'm in by seven. Board up, coffee, and my notebook open before the first tech clocks in. First thing I do is reconcile in my head what's actually on each truck against what the app thinks. They don't match by mid-week, so I trust the notebook."

A2. "The inventory view exists, I know it exists — but it's three taps deep and by the time I've drilled down I've forgotten which truck I was checking. So I write it on paper. It's faster and it's mine."

[Tell me about re-routes.]

A3. "Re-routing mid-day is the part of this job that ages me. One tech calls out and I'm on the phone to three or four others before the board even reflects it. I do it on the phone first, screen second, because the phone is the thing that's actually true."

A4. "The reassign flow on the board — it works, but it lags. I reassign a job and for a minute I don't know if it stuck. So I call the tech to confirm. Now I've done the same job twice."

A5. "I hate mid-day changes more than anything. A clean day I can run ninety techs in my sleep. It's the exceptions that eat me — the call-outs, the reschedules, the customer who moves their window."

[What happens at the end of the day?]

A6. "End of the day I'm here another forty-five minutes just typing in what came back on paper from the guys who couldn't submit in the field. Some nights closer to fifty. My family knows: if it's after six, it was a reconcile night."

A7. "The reconcile screen — it's long. I get to the parts-used step and something distracts me and I have to start over. I've abandoned it and restarted more times than I'll admit."

A8. "If somebody could give me those forty-five minutes back at the end of the day, that's the whole game. That's it. Everything else I can work around."

[What do you trust in the app?]

A9. "The arrival window. That I trust. My whole reputation is the arrival window — if I tell a customer 'between one and three' I will move heaven and earth to make that true, and the board shows me that piece honestly."

A10. "The inventory number by Thursday? No. It's always drifted. Payroll is usually how we find out something's off — the numbers don't add up and we go looking."

[Onboarding new dispatchers?]

A11. "The new ones never make it through the setup screens. There's a screen a few steps in where they just stop and come find me. I've started doing the setup for them at my desk. Faster than watching them stall."

A12. "Honestly? Half my day is keeping the picture straight in my head. The tools help with the picture. They don't hold it for me. I wish they held it for me."

Observed (ride-along, Tuesday shift)

- Copies truck stock into a paper notebook from memory + a quick app check before the shift starts.
- Re-routes by phone first, updates the board last (observed on a 9-minute call-out reassignment).
- Taps toward the inventory view, stops on the second screen, writes in the notebook instead.
- Spends ~45 minutes at reconcile typing six field techs' paper tickets; abandons the flow once and restarts.

Interview B — "Trey W."

Profile: 3 years dispatching · former field technician (5 years in the field) · 60-technician shop · confident, occasionally misremembers specifics

[What's your morning routine?]

B1. "I was a tech for five years, so the first thing I do every morning is open the mobile app on my own phone and look at the day the way my guys are going to see it. It's not always the same as what my dispatcher board shows me, and that gap is where problems start."

B2. "Being a former tech helps me more than any training FieldPulse gave me. I know why they cut corners, because I cut the same ones. When a tech 'forgets' to submit, I know it's because the submit failed and he's not going to fight it."

[You mentioned a sync gap — say more.]

B3. "When the schedule syncs slow, a tech shows up to a job that got moved twenty minutes ago. That happened to me — I want to say last month, could've been longer — and now I text them directly to be sure. I don't trust the push notification to beat the truck."

B4. "Actually, I think the notification does fire, it's just late. Or maybe it's the app not refreshing. I'm not sure which. All I know is the tech didn't see it in time." *[Note: Trey is uncertain about the mechanism here — Reported, not Observed.]*

[How's the in-app messaging?]

B5. "In-app messaging is fine until it's busy. When it's busy I go back to plain text messages, because I *know* those land. On a slow morning I'll use the app. On a Monday? Personal cell, every time."

[Reconcile?]

B6. "The reconcile screen at the end of the day — I watch guys just give up on it and hand me paper instead. So I do the reconcile myself for them. I'd rather do it right once than chase five half-done ones."

B7. "I don't need it to be pretty. I've said this to your rep. I need to trust that what's on my screen is what's actually happening in the field. Right now there's a lag between the field and the screen and I fill that lag with phone calls."

[If you could change one thing?]

B8. "Close the gap between the app and the board. If what I see and what my tech sees were the same thing at the same time, I'd stop texting people to double-check, and I'd get an hour back."

Observed (ride-along, Thursday shift)

- Opens the technician mobile app on his own phone and scrolls the day as a tech would before assigning.
 - A schedule change appears not to sync for several minutes; Trey texts the affected tech directly.
 - Watches a tech attempt a field submit, fail on weak signal, and set the ticket aside on paper — notes it without surprise.
 - At reconcile, does the paper tickets himself rather than ask techs to redo them in-app.
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Interview C — "Susana O."

Profile: 18 years dispatching · 160-technician shop · the owner's daughter · also runs weekly owner-facing reporting

[What does your week look like?]

C1. "I run the numbers for my dad every Friday. What he asks about is always the same two things: did we hit our windows, and did we bill everything we did. Eighteen years, same two questions."

C2. "But the real deadline isn't Friday — it's Wednesday. Payroll closes Wednesday afternoon. If a job isn't reconciled by then, the parts and the hours don't make it into that cycle, and now I'm chasing corrections into the next week. Wednesday is the wall everything runs into."

[Where does the system fall short?]

C3. "I keep a spreadsheet next to FieldPulse. Not because I want to — because there are three questions my dad asks that the reports can't answer in the shape he asks them. 'Completed versus billed' is the big one. It shows completed. It doesn't show billed. So I rebuild it by hand."

C4. "We miss revenue when work gets done and the paperwork doesn't catch up. That's the reconcile problem, and I want to be clear: it's a money problem, not a screen problem. Every job that's worked but not closed by Wednesday is a job we might not bill this cycle."

C5. "At our size, a half-percent of missed jobs is a real number. I can feel it before the report shows it. By Thursday I already know if it was a bad week."

[Onboarding?]

C6. "I train every new dispatcher personally. I can tell you the exact screen where they check out — it's the setup flow, about five screens in. Same screen, every hire. I've stopped expecting them to get through it alone."

[Where's the actual breakage?]

C7. "The techs aren't the problem. Everyone wants to blame the techs. The handoff between the office and the truck is where things fall on the floor. A job gets worked, the close-out doesn't happen or happens on paper, and it sits until someone like me goes looking."

C8. "If this told me on Wednesday morning what I currently only find out Friday afternoon, I'd get two days of my week back and we'd bill cleaner. That's the whole ask. Tell me sooner."

Observed (interviewer notes)

- Maintains a parallel spreadsheet for three owner-facing metrics not available in FieldPulse reports.
 - Reviews reconcile completeness against the Wednesday payroll cutoff; flags jobs worked-but-not-closed.
 - Onboards new dispatchers personally; three new hires observed stalling at the same setup step.
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A note on contradictions (leave them in)

These three don't fully agree. Maria's bottleneck is the 45-minute end-of-day retype; Susana's is the Wednesday payroll deadline; Trey's is the app-vs-board sync gap. All three touch "reconcile," but they mean different things by it. Resolving that — or deciding you can't — is your synthesis work.